

Bank of Leeds Strategic Infrastructure Proposal

Yorkshire Coast Railway Improvement Programme

A Targeted Upgrade to Connect Hull, Bridlington and Scarborough

Prepared for:

Bank of Leeds – Regional Infrastructure Investment Division

Investment Type:

Rail Infrastructure / Tourism Growth / Coastal Regeneration

Proposed Investment:

£450 million – £600 million

Delivery Period:

8–12 years

Executive Summary

The Bank of Leeds proposes a targeted redevelopment of the Yorkshire Coast railway line to create a faster, more reliable coastal transport corridor connecting:

Hull → Beverley → Bridlington → Filey → Scarborough

Rather than a full-scale high-speed railway, this proposal focuses on a realistic regional investment programme:

- targeted track upgrades,
- signalling improvements,
- station regeneration,
- improved rolling stock,
- summer tourism services.

The objective:

"Make the Yorkshire Coast accessible as a single tourism economy, linking Hull's maritime economy with Scarborough and Bridlington's visitor economies."

The project would not attempt to replace existing rail infrastructure, but upgrade the current line into a high-quality regional railway.

1. Strategic Case

The Yorkshire coast has a major economic opportunity:

- Scarborough is Yorkshire's largest seaside resort.
- Bridlington attracts significant family tourism.
- Filey provides coastal leisure.
- Hull provides the gateway through rail, ports and international connections.

However, the coastline remains fragmented.

Current challenges:

- slow journey times,
- limited service frequency,
- ageing infrastructure,
- poor perception of coastal rail travel.

A modest investment could unlock:

- more day trips,
 - more overnight tourism,
 - coastal regeneration,
 - improved employment access.
-

2. Proposed Investment Programme

Total Programme Cost

£500 million

Investment Area	Cost
Track improvements	£150m
Signalling upgrades	£100m
Station regeneration	£75m
Rolling stock improvements	£100m
Tourism marketing & integration	£25m
Contingency	£50m

3. Infrastructure Works

A. Line Speed Improvements

Investment:

£150 million

Current railway:

Primarily designed for local stopping services.

Target:

Increase average speeds through:

- track renewal,
 - curve improvements,
 - level crossing upgrades,
 - signalling improvements.
-

Journey Time Targets

Hull → Scarborough

Current:

~80 minutes

Target:

55–60 minutes

Hull → Bridlington

Current:

~45 minutes

Target:

30–35 minutes

Beverley → Scarborough

Current:

~60 minutes

Target:

40–45 minutes

4. Yorkshire Coast Express Service

Create a branded service:

Yorkshire Coast Express

Operating:

- hourly summer services,
 - enhanced weekends,
 - tourist specials.
-

Route:

Hull
|
Beverley
|
Bridlington
|
Filey
|
Scarborough

Potential extensions:

- Leeds summer services,
 - York tourist trains,
 - special event services.
-

5. Station Renaissance Programme

Investment:

£75 million

Focus:

Scarborough Station

£30m

Improvements:

- modern passenger facilities,
 - tourism information,
 - retail,
 - hotel integration.
-

Bridlington Station

£25m

Create:

"Gateway to the Yorkshire Coast"

Filey Station

£10m

Support:

- walking tourism,
 - cycling tourism,
 - coastal holidays.
-

Beverley

£10m

Improve connection with:

- Hull,
 - East Yorkshire tourism.
-

6. Tourism Strategy

The railway becomes part of a wider coastal tourism product.

Yorkshire Coast Rail Pass

A combined ticket:

Includes:

- railway travel,
 - attractions,
 - restaurants,
 - hotels.
-

Target customers:

Yorkshire Residents

Weekend trips:

Leeds → Coast

Sheffield → Coast

York → Coast

External Visitors

Markets:

- Manchester
 - Midlands
 - London
-

7. Summer Seasonal Expansion

The railway is particularly valuable because coastal tourism is seasonal.

The Bank of Leeds proposal would create:

Summer Coastal Timetable

April–September:

- additional trains,
 - late evening services,
 - family tourism trains.
-

Special services:

The Yorkshire Seaside Express

Luxury day-trip service.

Ticket:

£75–100

Includes:

- reserved seating,
 - food,
 - coastal guide.
-

8. Financial Model

Passenger Growth

Current corridor:

estimated annual passengers:

~1.5–2 million journeys

Target:

4 million journeys annually

Revenue

Average fare:

£10

Additional journeys:

2 million

Additional annual revenue:

£20 million

Tourism Impact

Additional visitors:

500,000–750,000/year

Average visitor spend:

£120

Additional tourism economy:

£60–90 million/year

9. GDP Impact

A regional infrastructure project of this size would have effects through:

- tourism spending,
- construction,
- property development,
- employment mobility.

Conservative estimate:

Annual Yorkshire economic uplift:

£150–250 million per year

10-year cumulative impact:

£1.5–2.5 billion

10. Coastal Regeneration Effects

Improved railway access supports:

Scarborough

Potential:

- hotel investment,
 - restaurants,
 - cultural events.
-

Bridlington

Potential:

- family tourism,
 - holiday accommodation,
 - leisure investment.
-

Filey

Potential:

- boutique tourism,
 - retirement economy,
 - walking tourism.
-

11. Housing Impact

Better connectivity increases investment confidence.

Potential:

New housing around:

- Beverley,
- Bridlington,
- Filey,
- Scarborough.

Estimated:

3,000–5,000 additional homes over 20 years.

12. Bank of Leeds Financing Model

Yorkshire Coast Connectivity Bond

Issue Size:

£500 million

Term:

30 years

Funding Sources:

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£200m
Government partnership	£200m
Pension/infrastructure investors	£100m

Repayment Sources

Supported by:

- passenger revenue,
 - commercial development,
 - station property,
 - increased business rates.
-

13. Employment Impact

Construction Phase

8–10 years:

5,000 job-years

Permanent Employment

Rail:

500 jobs

Tourism:

1,500 jobs

Hospitality:

2,000 jobs

Total:

4,000+ jobs

14. Strategic Importance

The project links three economies:

Hull

Industrial and maritime economy.

East Yorkshire

Agriculture and tourism.

Scarborough

Coastal visitor economy.

Together:

A Yorkshire coastal economic corridor.

15. Delivery Timeline

Phase 1 (2026–2030)

£200m

- signalling,

- stations,
 - timetable improvements.
-

Phase 2 (2030–2035)

£200m

- track improvements,
 - rolling stock.
-

Phase 3 (2035–2040)

£100m

- tourism expansion,
 - premium services.
-

Final Recommendation

The Bank of Leeds should support:

Yorkshire Coast Railway Improvement Programme

with:

£500 million investment capacity.

Final Investment Thesis

The Yorkshire coast does not require a new high-speed railway.

It requires a **better regional railway**.

A targeted £500 million investment could:

- cut journey times by 25–30%,
- increase tourism,
- regenerate coastal towns,
- connect Hull with the seaside economy,
- create thousands of jobs.

The strategic vision:

"One railway. One coast. One Yorkshire visitor economy."